My Foundation Statement

Written by Sam Parent

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PURPOSE

A short reflection I wrote to prepare for our conversation. It captures how I'm thinking about our co-parenting right now - from my child's perspective, from my co-parent's perspective, and from my own. It is not a set of demands and it is not a court filing.

THROUGH MY CHILD'S EYES

Through Jordan's eyes I see a kid who wants both of us at his soccer games - he does not care who bought the boots. He watches how we talk to each other more than he listens to what we actually say. When Riley and I are cordial at handovers, Jordan settles within ten minutes. When we are tense, he stays quiet for the rest of the evening. I want him to remember his childhood as loved and steady, not as a series of loyalty tests.

MY OWN PART

My own part is that I let small annoyances build up rather than raising them the same week. By the time I bring something up it has become an accusation instead of a request. I also default to text messages when a five-minute phone call would be quicker and warmer. I am working on waiting until I am calm before I send, and picking up the phone for anything longer than one sentence.

MY BEST-CASE OUTCOME

A predictable week-on / week-off schedule that both of us trust. Clear rules on who handles which appointments so neither of us is guessing. A shared calendar for the kids' activities. Space for either of us to swap a weekend without it becoming a negotiation. Above all, a working relationship where Jordan and Alex can talk to either of us about the other without worrying.

THROUGH MY CO-PARENT'S EYES

Through Riley's eyes I imagine they see me as still holding on to how things ended. They probably wish I would let go of the 60/40 argument from last year and focus on what works from here. They may feel I am quicker to reply to my own family than to their messages. I would want them to know I am doing this work because I want us to co-parent well, not because I have anything to prove.

BEFORE THIS DOCUMENT IS USED IN A COURT, MEDIATION, OR LEGAL SETTING

- Completed by Sam Parent - the parent named above filled in every answer themselves.
- Answers are self-reported and not verified by a licensed clinician, court officer, or independent evaluator.
- Only one parent completed this reflection - the other parent's perspective is not included.
- This is not a custody evaluation and is not intended to replace one.
- Scores and dimensions are educational reflections - they are not clinical findings, diagnoses, or risk determinations.
- Nothing in this document is a recommendation about the child's best interest. Best-interest decisions are for the parents, their professionals, and - where appropriate - the court.

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